

WEEKLY GYM WORKOUT PLAN

UCF Recreation & Wellness Center · Beginner Strength & Stamina Program · 06:00–07:00 Morning Sessions

MONDAY — Core & Functional Strength

Moderate Intensity

WARM-UP (8 min): 5 min treadmill walk · Leg swings × 10 · Hip circles × 10 · Arm circles × 10

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Coaching Note
Plank	3	45 sec	Elbows under shoulders, hips level
Dead Bug	3	12/side	Slow & controlled, lower back flat
Cable Crunch / Crunch Machine	3	15	Squeeze abs, don't pull with neck
Pallof Press (anti-rotation)	3	12/side	Stand tall, resist rotation
DB Romanian Deadlift (light)	3	12	Hinge at hips, soft knees
Bird Dog	3	12/side	Pause at top of each rep
Farmer's Carry (dumbbells)	3	30 m	Stand tall, shoulders back

COOL-DOWN (10 min): Child's pose · Cat-cow × 10 · Lying spinal twist · Hip flexor stretch

TUESDAY — Upper Body Push (Chest · Shoulders · Triceps)

Moderate Intensity

WARM-UP (8 min): Arm circles × 15 · Band pull-aparts × 15 · 5 min light rowing machine

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Coaching Note
Dumbbell Bench Press	3	12	Control the descent
Incline Dumbbell Press	3	12	30–45° incline, upper chest
Cable Chest Fly	3	15	Wide arc, squeeze at midline
Dumbbell Shoulder Press	3	12	Don't arch lower back
Dumbbell Lateral Raise	3	15	Light weight, slight elbow bend
Tricep Rope Pushdown (cable)	3	15	Elbows pinned, full extension
Overhead DB Tricep Extension	3	12	Both hands on one DB, elbows in

COOL-DOWN (10 min): Chest doorway stretch · Shoulder cross-body stretch · Tricep overhead stretch

WEDNESDAY — Lower Body (Quads · Hamstrings · Glutes · Calves)

Moderate Intensity

WARM-UP (8 min): 5 min easy bike · Leg swings × 10 · Bodyweight squats × 10 (slow)

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Coaching Note
Goblet Squat (dumbbell)	3	15	Chest tall, knees track toes
Leg Press Machine	3	12	Don't lock knees at top
Dumbbell Walking Lunge	3	10/leg	Long stride, back knee near floor
Seated Leg Curl Machine	3	12	Full range, no jerking
Glute Bridge (bodyweight)	3	15	Drive through heels, squeeze top
Standing Calf Raise	3	20	2 sec up · 2 hold · 2 down
Step-Ups (box + dumbbells)	3	10/leg	Full hip extension at top

COOL-DOWN (10 min): Quad stretch · Hamstring stretch · Pigeon pose 45 sec/side · Calf stretch

THURSDAY — Back Strength (Lats · Traps · Rear Delts)

Moderate Intensity

WARM-UP (8 min): 5 min rowing machine (light) · Cat-cow × 10 · Shoulder rotations × 15

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Coaching Note
Lat Pulldown (cable)	3	12	Pull to upper chest, lean back slightly
Seated Cable Row	3	12	Elbows drive back, squeeze blades
DB Single-Arm Row	3	12/arm	Flat back, elbow drives to hip
Face Pull (cable rope)	3	15	External rotation, elbows high
Bent-Over Rear Delt Fly (DB)	3	15	Arms arc out wide
Dumbbell Shrugs	3	15	Straight up, 1 sec hold, no rolling
TRX Row / Assisted Pull-Up Machine	3	10	Full stretch down, full contraction up

COOL-DOWN (10 min): Lat stretch · Child's pose · Thoracic rotation · Upper trap stretch

FRIDAY — Arms & Biceps (Biceps · Forearms · Light Triceps)

Light–Moderate Intensity

WARM-UP (8 min): 5 min light elliptical · Wrist circles × 10 · Arm swings across body × 15

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Coaching Note
Dumbbell Bicep Curl	3	15	Full range, don't swing elbows
Hammer Curl	3	15	Neutral grip, targets brachialis
Cable Bicep Curl	3	15	Constant tension, slow negatives
Incline Dumbbell Curl	3	12	Full stretch at bottom
EZ-Bar / Barbell Curl	3	12	Elbows tucked at sides
Wrist Curls (DB, seated)	3	20	Forearm on thigh, full range
Overhead Rope Extension (light)	3	15	Keeps arms balanced

COOL-DOWN (10 min): Bicep wall stretch · Wrist flexor stretch · Wrist extensor stretch · Forearm massage

SATURDAY — Full Body Light Circuit (Active Recovery)

Light Intensity — 3 Rounds · 45 sec work / 15 sec rest

WARM-UP (8 min): 5 min treadmill walk/jog · Full body dynamic stretch head to toe

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Coaching Note
Bodyweight Squat	3 rds	45 sec	Slow and controlled
Push-Up (or knee push-up)	3 rds	45 sec	Quality over quantity
TRX Row	3 rds	45 sec	Body at 45°, row to chest
Reverse Lunge (bodyweight)	3 rds	45 sec	Alternate legs
Plank Hold	3 rds	45 sec	Breathe steadily
DB Shoulder Press (light)	3 rds	45 sec	3–5 kg dumbbells
Step Touches / Jumping Jacks	3 rds	45 sec	Gentle heart rate

COOL-DOWN (10 min): Full body static stretch routine — hold each stretch 30 seconds

SUNDAY — REST DAY ★

No gym. The body builds muscle during recovery, not the workout. Sleep, hydrate, eat well, light walk, meal prep, call home, enjoy the day.

EVENING CARDIO SESSION (17:30–18:30 — Separate from Morning Gym)

Activity	Suggested Days	Where at UCF
Jogging / Running	Mon · Wed · Fri	Campus paths, RWC Park
Cycling	Tue · Thu	Campus cycle routes
Swimming	Saturday	RWC Lap Pool — Mon–Fri 06:00–19:00, Sat 11:00–17:00
Walk & Explore	Any day	Campus cafes, new spots — lower intensity option

Tip: On heavy gym days, dial back evening intensity — a brisk walk counts. Consistency beats perfection.

Step 1 — Fitness Assessment (Start Here)

Free — book at ucf.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_2uFJlOmriZfGWhw
Start here. 1-on-1 with Certified Trainer: body composition + baseline measurements + personalised recommendations.

Step 2 — Personal Training

By appt at RWC Main · Walk-ins at RWC Downtown · fitness@ucf.edu · 407-823-2408
Nationally certified trainers (ACE/ACSM/NASM/ISSA/NSCA). Custom program for your goals. Initial Consultation required.

Step 3 — Group Exercise Classes (Free)

Free · 60+ classes/week · Reserve 24h before at ucfrwc.org · Arrive 15 min early
Best beginner classes: KnightFit (full body), Cycle+Strength (legs+cardio), Pilates (core), Yoga (recovery), HIIT (stamina — start after 4–6 weeks).

KEY REMINDERS

- Eat a light protein snack 30–45 min before training (banana + peanut butter, or boiled egg).
- Bring a full water bottle — drink between every set.
- Warm-up and cool-down protect you from injury — never skip them.
- Never train to failure as a beginner — stop 2–3 reps before you can't continue.
- Log your weights in a notebook or phone — progressive overload is how you get stronger.
- Pain (not muscle burn) → stop and visit RWC Athletic Training Room (Tue–Thu 13:30–17:00).

4-WEEK PROGRESS TRACKER

Week	Mon Core	Tue Upper	Wed Legs	Thu Back	Fri Arms	Sat Circuit	Sun Rest
Week 1	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]
Week 2	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]
Week 3	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]
Week 4	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]

Review at end of Week 4: note weight increases and discuss progression with your Personal Trainer.